

Web Watch

Some big predictions for the future of the web are covered this time. Also mentioned are some social initiatives revolving around the internet

App Watch

Play around with these apps that enhance your driving experience. Then, check out Tata Sky's Live TV app

It's time to ramp up the internals

This month saw chip makers introduce faster and more efficient chipsets and not too far behind, phone manufacturers released a slew of new phones

The Snapdragon 805 is here

Qualcomm has unveiled its latest new generation Snapdragon 805 chipset with a quad-core processor which has clock speeds of upto 2.5Ghz along with support for 4K graphics.

In addition to 4K display support, it will also support 4K video recording, already available on Snapdragon 800. Notably, the new SoC features a brand new Adreno 420 GPU, which has 40 percent more processing power than its predecessor, the Adreno 330. It also comes with improved processing power. The cores have a new Krait 450 architecture with a maximum clock speed of 2.5 Ghz and memory bandwidth of up to 25.6 GB/s.

Along with that, Qualcomm has also embedded a brand new modem dubbed 'Gobi 9x35'. It's manufactured on a 20nm process, delivers better power

efficiency, is smaller and, obviously, much faster. It also supports LTE Category 4, dual-band 802.11ac Wi-Fi along with support for 4K video streaming via Wi-Fi.

Executive Vice President of Qualcomm Technologies, Murthy Renduchintala said in a press release, "Using a smartphone or tablet powered by Snapdragon 805 processor is like having an UltraHD home theater in your pocket, with 4K video, imaging, and graphics, all built for mobile. Coupled with our industry leading Gobi LTE modems and RF transceivers, streaming and watching content at 4K resolution will finally be possible."

That's not all, Qualcomm has also added a new dedicated camera processor to the new Snapdragon 805 chipset, which will increase camera speed and might even boost the quality of images. It will also feature a Gyro sensor to stabilise the captured images.

Qualcomm is all geared up for mass production of the Snapdragon 805 chipsets and we should see them on devices by the first half of 2014.

The new Snapdragon 805 appears to be a substantial upgrade over its predecessor. Only time will tell if it will be as successful as the Snapdragon 800.



LG is reportedly entering the SoC space

Meet LG's 'Odin' SoC

Taking a cue from Qualcomm and of course not one to be left behind, LG seems to be making its entry into the SoC space. And why not? Every other phone manufacturer worth its salt seems to be baking its own chips now. Going by what's being reported by a Korean newspaper, LG too has officially confirmed reports of its own smartphone chipset called the 'Odin'. The SoC will come in two versions – Quad core (running at up to 2.2 Ghz per core and including an ARM Mali-T604 GPU) and Octa core.

The eight-core version of the Odin may be paired with ARM's latest Mali-T760 GPU. The two SoCs are reportedly being tested as of now. Taiwanese manufacturer TSMC will be manufacturing these SoCs as LG doesn't have its own facility. Rumours regarding the launch of a mobile

processor from LG have been around since the first half of this year. Earlier it was believed that Odin would power the LG G2. However, LG will reportedly use the quad-core Odin for its smart TVs, while the octa-core will be used in smartphones and tablets.

There's no official confirmation of the exact date of its debut. We'll have to wait for LG to officially announce the above claims.

Phone manufacturers can't be too far behind

Not to be outdone by all this talk of SoCs, chipsets and processors, phone manufacturers too came out with some tricked out offerings over the month gone by. HTC launched its One Max, a massive 5.9-inch quad-core Android phablet priced at an MoP of ₹56,490 and MRP of ₹61,490. The One Max is



4K and Wi-Fi 802.11 on mobile can mean some serious game changes